City of Aurora

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November 10, 2026

PROJECT NO. B-4799
Ash Tree Treatment

ADDENDUM NUMBER TWO

Scope of this Addendum

This Addendum Number Two serves to distribute the Answers to Vendor Questions for IFB #B-4799. These modifications have been deemed necessary by the City of Aurora.

If you have any questions or concerns regarding this addendum document, please contact Zac Felts at ZFelts@auroragov.org.

This Addendum Number Two supersedes and/or supplements all portions of the Contract Documents with which it conflicts.

The total number of pages contained in this Addendum Number Two is one (1) cover page and thirteen (31) informational pages.

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End of Addendum Number Two

Zac Felts
Procurement Agent

IFB #B-4799 - Ash Tree Treatment

Answers to Vendor Questions

1. Do you know the application rate that is required for this job. Most pesticide labels have a high, medium, low rate and that effects pricing.
   Dosage requirements will vary based on tree size and the proximity of the existing infestation. Therefore, we request that all bidders provide separate per-diameter-inch rates for low, medium, and high treatment doses. The City anticipates administering the medium dose to most trees and will use the medium-dose rate as the basis for evaluating and comparing bid prices. The pricing sheet has been updated to reflect these changes.

2. Manufacturers of Emamectin benzoate provide a chart for low, medium, and high dosage. Which application rate is requested by Aurora?
   See response 1.

3. Ash are vulnerable to leaf drop if temperatures drop during early leaf emergence (this happened metro-wide in May 2026). Most Ash were therefore not in full leaf until early June. Will Aurora provide an adequate application window if late leaf-out occurs?
   The City intends to schedule treatments during the spring, as this is generally considered the most effective treatment window under typical weather conditions. Should weather or other factors necessitate adjustments, the treatment schedule will be modified through mutual agreement between the City and the contractor.

4. SBE Participation Requirements
   The solicitation does not appear to include the City's standard 10% SBE good-faith participation provisions. Can you confirm whether these requirements apply to B-4799? If not, is their exclusion based on the $125,000 initial project budget?

   $125000 is cost for application, no administrative cost will be involved.

5. Contract Value and Renewal Options
   Since this solicitation includes four optional annual renewals, is the $250,000 SBE threshold evaluated based on the initial contract value or the estimated total contract value, including renewal options?

   We will evaluate based on initial contract value (i.e. $125,000)

6. SBE Participation by Large-Business Contractors
   If a large-business prime contractor is awarded B-4799 and intends to

subcontract part of the work, would the City's 10% SBE good-faith requirement apply? If not, could you clarify why it would not apply to this solicitation?

No, we are not expecting any sub-contracting for this project.

7. NAICS Code and SBE Classification
   Section IV lists the NAICS code and small-business size standard as "XX." Could the City provide the applicable NAICS code and size standard so bidders can accurately determine and report their SBE status?

   The North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code for this award is: 115310

   The small business size standard the City of Aurora designates for this award is $5.5 million U.S. dollars

8. SBE Status and Award Evaluation
   For this solicitation, is the SBE designation collected solely for reporting purposes, or is there any applicable SBE consideration in the evaluation or award process?

   SBE status is not taken into account for the evaluation criteria or award process

9. Pre-Solicitation SBE Outreach
   Prior to issuing IFB B-4799, did the City conduct any outreach or review its SBE vendor directory to identify qualified Small Business Enterprises capable of performing these services? If so, what outreach efforts were undertaken to notify or encourage SBE participation in this procurement?

   Yes, we informed all vendors who are in contact with City of Auora through one online meeting.

Please omit the requesting vendor's name, company information, and other identifying details from any publicly posted questions and answers. If this cannot be accommodated, please advise before publication.

10. Trunk Injection Product: Section I specifies emamectin benzoate (minimum 4% active ingredient), while Attachment A identifies abamectin benzoate. Please confirm the required active ingredient and whether a corrected pricing sheet will be issued.

Emamectin benzoate throughout the solicitation document indicates minimum 4% active ingredients. Refer Question 1 for further details.

11. Treatment Schedule / Seasonal Restrictions: Given the anticipated November 2026 start date and the requirement that trees be actively transpiring, please confirm that trunk injection treatments may commence in spring 2027 without a minimum winter production requirement.

    To ensure funding is reserved in the City's FY 2026 budget, this project is being initiated during the current year. Treatment applications will be performed next year during the appropriate seasonal window, consistent with industry standards and treatment requirements

12. Applicator Licensing: If all proposed applicators hold valid Colorado Department of Agriculture Qualified Supervisor (QS) licenses, is a separate Qualified Operator (QO) license required for bid responsiveness?

    All the people involved in this project should have applicable licenses from Colorado Department of Agriculture. You should have at least one QS holder and other team members who will be involved in application should also have valid licenses like CO.

13. Manufacturer Training: Must proof of manufacturer training for the selected product and injection equipment be submitted with the bid, or may training be completed and documented prior to commencing treatments?

    We need the training evidence submitted in the bid document to evaluate it.

14. Water Supply & Post-Application Watering Specifications: Section I, §4.5 specifies post-application watering at a rate of 10 gallons per DBH inch, and Attachment A requires watering to be included in the soil drenching unit price. Please clarify the intended watering method and application area. Is the contractor expected to water only the root flare and immediate treatment area, or the tree's broader root zone? Additionally, will the City provide access to water, or must the contractor furnish and transport all required water? Please provide any additional watering specifications necessary to ensure consistent and accurate pricing.

    We anticipate that a one-time watering of the broader root zone area will be necessary to improve the effectiveness of soil drench treatments. The contractor shall be responsible for providing and managing all required watering activities.

    If needed, the City will assist the contractor in obtaining access to designated hydrants through Aurora Water, subject to Aurora Water's policies and

approval process. The contractor shall be responsible for all associated fees, charges, permits, and water usage costs.

15. Tree Eligibility / Rejected Treatments: If a tree identified by the City is determined to be ineligible for treatment due to canopy decline, environmental conditions, or a property-owner opt-out, may the contractor omit that tree without penalty? Would any associated inspection or mobilization costs be compensable?

    Yes, tree list will be provided by the city so no inspection will be necessary from bidder's side. For any unavoidable situation, it will be resolved mutually.

16. Bid Evaluation Methodology: Please clarify whether award will be based primarily on the lowest trunk injection unit price or an evaluated combination of both treatment methods. If both methods are considered, please identify the applicable quantities or weighting.

    It will be evaluated based primarily on Trunk Injection method (medium dose). Soil drenching will be treated as secondary during evaluation.

17. Estimated Treatment Quantities: Please provide the anticipated number of trees, approximate DBH ranges, and estimated total DBH inches for each treatment method.

    The number of trees selected for treatment will depend on the per-DBH-inch unit prices submitted by the bidders. The City's budget for this project is limited to $125,000; however, the number of candidate trees eligible for treatment exceeds the available funding. Therefore, the final number of trees to be treated will be determined after bid prices are received and evaluated.

18. Renewal Pricing: The contract provides for an initial one-year term with four optional annual renewals. Will renewal-year unit pricing be established at the time of each extension, or is the City expecting the initial bid rates to remain fixed throughout the potential five-year term?

    Price will be adjusted as per Market rate during the time of each extension, if any.

19. GIS Reporting Requirements: Will the City provide contractor access to its ESRI GIS system, including required data fields and instructions for updating treatment records?

The city plans to develop an Ash Tree Treatment Dashboard that will be integrated with Esri. The contractor will be provided with access to the dashboard and will be responsible for entering and updating all required treatment and inspection data within the system

20. Weather-Related Schedule Extensions: Will extensions to the June 2027 completion deadline be considered when weather, soil conditions, or seasonal dormancy prevent label-compliant treatments?

    Under normal weather conditions, treatments will be performed during the spring season. Any adjustments required due to unforeseen weather conditions will be made through mutual agreement between the City and the contractor.

21. Professional Liability Insurance: Please confirm whether the $2 million professional liability insurance requirement applies to this pesticide treatment contract.

Professional Liability will not be required. Final insurance amounts shall be:

1. General Liability Insurance: The Contractor shall maintain Commercial General Liability (CGL) insurance with minimum limits of $1,000,000 per occurrence and $2,000,000 aggregate, covering bodily injury, personal injury, property damage, products/completed operations, and premises/operations. Policies shall contain no pesticide application exclusions.

2. Automobile Liability Insurance: The Contractor shall maintain Commercial Automobile Liability insurance with a minimum limit of $1,000,000 combined single limit, covering all owned, hired, and non-owned vehicles used in the performance of this contract.

3. Workers' Compensation Insurance: with limits in accordance with the provisions of the Workers' Compensation Act, as amended, by the State of Colorado and Employers Liability Insurance with minimum limits of: $1,000,000 bodily injury for each accident, $1,000,000 bodily injury by disease each employee and $1,000,000 bodily injury disease aggregate.

4. Pesticide Applicator Liability Insurance: The Contractor shall maintain Pesticide Applicator Liability insurance with minimum limits of $1,000,000 per occurrence and $1,000,000 aggregate, covering drift, misapplication, environmental impairment, and chemical injection operations.

5. Pollution / Environmental Liability: If not included within the Contractor's CGL or Pesticide Applicator policy, the Contractor shall maintain Pollution Liability insurance

with minimum limits of $1,000,000 per occurrence, covering chemical spills, soil contamination, waterway contamination, and cleanup costs.

All other terms and conditions shall still apply.

22. Treatment Flexibility: Would the City allow trunk injection on ash trees greater than 8- or 10-inches DBH, with soil drenching reserved for smaller trees, if this approach could reduce costs?

    The City does not anticipate using trunk injection treatments on ash trees smaller than 12 inches DBH. However, certain trees under 12 inches DBH that are in strategic or high-priority areas may be considered for treatment using soil drench applications.

23. Soil Drench Water Requirements: Is the specified 10 gallons of water per DBH inch mandatory, or can contractors follow manufacturer recommendations?

    Manufacturer recommendations will be followed but you can plan your cost as if it is mandatory.

24. Water Availability: Will the City provide access to water for soil drenching, or must the contractor supply and transport it?

    Suppliers should be responsible for this. They may need to go through Aurora Water to get access and hydrant meter as per their policy if necessary.

25. Fall Inventory: Can the contractor begin tree inventory, DBH measurements, condition assessments, and GIS updates in fall 2026, with treatments beginning in spring 2027?

    The City will be responsible for conducting the tree inventory and will furnish the contractor with a complete treatment list after the Purchase Order (PO) is issued. As such, bid prices shall cover treatment-related services only and shall exclude any costs for tree inventory, assessment, or selection.

26. Inventory Billing: Can completed fall inventory work be invoiced separately before spring treatments, or must those costs be included in the treatment price per DBH inch?

    The City will be responsible for conducting the tree inventory and will furnish the contractor with a complete treatment list after the Purchase Order (PO) is issued. As such, bid prices shall cover treatment-related services only and shall exclude any costs for tree inventory, assessment, or selection.

27. Chemical Specification: Section 4.1 specifies emamectin benzoate, while Attachment A specifies abamectin benzoate. Which product is required?

    Refer Question 1 for detail.

28. Manufacturer Training: Can proof of manufacturer training be submitted after contract award but before treatments begin?

    Yes, it will be a part of bid document evaluation.

29. Insurance Requirements: Is the $2 million professional liability insurance requirement applicable to this contract?

    See Question #21

30. Treatment Quantities: Can the City provide estimated treatment quantities and DBH ranges for both injection and soil drenching?
    Yes

31. 2027 Funding: Will funding be secured for work extending into 2027, and how will completed 2026 inventory work be compensated if funding or treatment quantities change?

    The City currently has **$125,000** allocated for this project. While there is a strong likelihood that treatments will continue in future years in accordance with the recommended treatment intervals (e.g., trunk injections every 2-3 years and soil drench applications annually), no future funding is guaranteed at this time. This solicitation is for the current project period only.

32. The soil drench with Dinotefuran.
    A more efficient means of application would be a trunk spray.
    This is to be directed to trees that fall below the injection minimum <4".
    The spray can be quick and efficient using the least amount of product for effective treatment.
    Soil Drench adds larger volumes to the soil potentially impacting negatively the soil micro biome.
    Following up with 10 gallons per caliper inch does increase the trees uptake but also flushes chemicals towards water table.

    The City does not anticipate treating trees smaller than 4 inches in diameter (DBH). If any trees below this threshold are selected for treatment, they will be limited to a small number of strategically important locations.
    The City will not utilize aerial pesticide applications as part of this project.

I request the option for trunk spray timed before tree flowering for all trees <4" designated for EAB protection.

In addition, a note to allow the use of non organo silicate wetting agent and bark penaterate to aid in the efficacy of the product absorption.

Protecting all ash trees in the City is not the objective of this program. With an estimated **4,700 ash trees** citywide, the City's management approach combines proactive tree removal, replacement, and targeted treatments. Treatment activities under this contract will be limited to designated specimen and priority ash trees.

33. Clarification of the Timeline. Trees treated with any type of systemic (injection or soil) require the tree to be fully leafed out with good vascular movement. This is typically Mid to late May for the Denver Metro area.

    The current project timeline listed in Section 1 Scope of Services. "The project will start in November 2026, and treatment will be completed by June 2027". I would recommend the timeline be listed as May Through June or July 2027. This provides some grace period for inclement weather. This 2026 season had a late freeze that impacted ash new growth and pushed back the application window. If spring is delayed by cold temps, all natural processes will be delayed as well. If Spring comes early, all natural process will also come early. This should be sufficient time to complete the desired work within the optimal treatment window.

    Refer to question no 11. Situation arising due to weather will be discussed and agreed upon in due time.

34. The scope (Section 4.1) specifies Emamectin Benzoate, but the Pricing Sheet lists "Abamectin Benzoate." Please confirm the pricing line should read Emamectin Benzoate.

    Refer to question no 10

35. The dinotefuran product is listed as "Transect." Please confirm this means Transtect.

    That's an auto correction typo error. You can read Transtect. Please disregard this error.

36. The Confidentiality section refers to a letter "found in Section VI," but the Open Records form is Section V and Section VI is the W-9. Please confirm which form must be signed to protect confidential information.

The Confidentiality section should have read “found in Section V”. Confirming Section V: Open Records Request must be signed to protect confidential information

37. The page footer on the Reporting section references "IFB-B-4794 As-Needed Tires and Tire Repair/Replacement Services." Please confirm that section belongs to this IFB.
    Confirmed. The footer should read “IFB #B-4799 - Ash Tree Treatment”. Please disregard this error.

38. Section IV lists the NAICS code and small business size standard as "XX." Please provide the intended values.
    Please refer to the answer provide to Question #7

39. Work is scheduled to start November 30, but both treatments depend on active transpiration, and the scope prohibits injection when trees are not transpiring. Does the City expect any treatments this winter, or will work be scheduled for spring 2027 (roughly April through June)?

    City will not be doing any treatment in winter. It will be done in Spring/Summer.

40. The Background states the program begins in September 2026, while the timeline says November 2026. Which is correct, and have any of these trees already been treated?

    Refer to question # 11.

41. The Background states the program begins in September 2026, while the timeline says November 2026. Which is correct, and have any of these trees already been treated?

    We did treat some trees, but it will not be part of this project.

42. How will the 20% canopy decline requirement be assessed if tree lists are prepared during the dormant season? If a contractor finds an assigned tree ineligible at the time of treatment, will a replacement tree be assigned?

    This criterion will be used in evaluating treatment eligibility. If a tree meets the conditions for removal rather than treatment, the City will be responsible for providing a replacement tree.

43. Which emamectin benzoate products are acceptable (for example, 4% vs. higher-concentration formulations), and will the City accept any labeled product that meets the 4% minimum?

    Refer question no 1

44. Should pricing be based on a specific label rate (low vs. high rate), and is the City expecting two-year or three-year protection from the injection?

    Bid evaluations will be based on the medium-dose unit rate submitted by each bidder. The number of trees selected for treatment will be determined using the awarded medium-dose rate and the available project budget. The City expects treatments to provide approximately 2 to 3 years of protection under typical conditions.

45. Section 5.4.2 requires "manufacturer-approved closed-system injection equipment" and also states that "injection lines and plugs" must be secure. We currently use plugless injection equipment supplied by Rainbow Ecoscience. Will a plugless, manufacturer-approved injection system be acceptable under this contract?

    Closed system injection is mentioned from environmental and workers safety points of view. We will also accept plug less injection that are being used in the industry.

46. Would the City accept dinotefuran soil injection or basal trunk spray as an alternative to soil drench where the label allows it? Soil injections often use less product and reduces runoff risk.

    Yes. For evaluation purposes, the city will place primary emphasis on the bidder's trunk injection pricing (medium dose). Rates for soil drenching treatments will be reviewed as ancillary services and will serve as secondary considerations during the bid evaluation process.

47. What DBH range should be expected for soil drench trees? Is there an upper size limit?

    Our plan is for those trees less than 12” Dbh and this number will be very low.

48. The 10 gallons per DBH inch watering requirement is substantial (200 gallons for a 20-inch tree). Will the City provide access to water sources such as hydrants or park irrigation, and are hydrant meters or permits needed?

    This is only for soil drenching techniques, and we will not be doing it for larger size trees. Refer Qs 14

49. Does the watering requirement apply only to soil drench trees, or also to trunk injection trees?

    It is only for Soil drenching techniques

50. Should watering costs be included in the per-DBH-inch drench price, as the Pricing Sheet suggests?

Yes

51. Can the City share an estimated number of trees and total DBH inches for each method, along with the general distribution of locations? This affects mobilization and unit pricing.

    Trees will be throughout the city. Total number depends upon the per inch diameter rate of the bidders. We will provide the number once we receive the unit rate. For general overview, Aurora's public tree map is available at Aurora Trees.

52. Is there a minimum guaranteed volume, or is the full $125,000 contingent on the final tree list?

    We want to use full $125000.

53. For renewal years, is re-treatment of the same trees anticipated, and should bidders assume pricing is held for re-treatment cycles?

    This solicitation covers the initial treatment cycle only. The City is actively developing the internal capacity to perform these treatments with City staff in the future; however, building the necessary staffing, training, equipment, and operational processes will take time.
    As a result, the City anticipates continuing to utilize the selected contractor for future treatment cycles of these trees, subject to satisfactory performance, available funding, and City approval. Any future work and associated pricing will be negotiated separately and adjusted to reflect prevailing market conditions at the time.

54. The IFB references a "Qualified Operator (QO)" license. Colorado's categories are Qualified Supervisor, Certified Operator, and Registered Technician. Please clarify which credentials are acceptable for applicators working under a QS.
    Qualified Operations are defined as QS, CO, and RT. All treatment activities shall be directed and overseen by a QS. CO and RT personnel should be working under the supervision of QS.

55. If all applicators hold QS licenses, is a separate QO license copy still mandatory?
    All personnel involved in treatment activities shall possess the appropriate applicator licenses required for their assigned duties. Treatment operations shall be supervised and directed by an individual holding a valid Qualified Supervisor (QS) license.
    Bidders shall submit copies of all applicable licenses and certifications for the personnel proposed to perform and supervise the treatment work.

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56. What documentation satisfies "proof of manufacturer training"? Does this apply to the soil drench product as well as the injection product and equipment?

Bidders shall submit training certificates or other documentation acceptable to the City that verifies successful completion of relevant treatment training by the proposed personnel. This requirement applies to all personnel involved in both trunk injection and soil treatment methods, including supervision and application activities

57. Section II asks for a service plan addressing "maximum number of requests (calls) per day," ordering items not in stock, and photos within a prescribed time, which appear to be from a different solicitation. Which elements apply to this project?
    Section II, subsection 3 shall be disregarded

58. Since award is to the lowest responsive, responsible bidder, how will the Statement of Qualifications be used in evaluation? Is it pass/fail?

    The lowest submitted unit price for trunk injection treatments (Medium Dose category) will serve as the primary evaluation and selection criterion for this project. However, bidders must also demonstrate compliance with all qualifications, licensing, training, and project requirements specified in the solicitation. The City reserves the right to award the contract to the lowest-priced bidder in the Medium Dose category only if the bidder is determined to be fully responsive and responsible

59. Our team currently has access to Field Maps. Will the City allow treatment and inventory data to be entered directly into Field Maps in the field at the time of application to the City's GIS system?

    Probably yes. We are thinking of developing a Dashboard for a contractor to record the treatment information in ESRI system.

60. If treatment data is entered directly in Field Maps, will that satisfy the biweekly reporting requirement in Section 7, or does the City still require a separate completed-work list to accompany each invoice? If a separate list is required, would an export from the Field Maps layer be acceptable?
    For invoice purposes, contractor should submit the report as outlined in Scope of the work Document.

61. Can the City confirm which layer and data fields should be used for this project (for example, product, batch number, applicator license number, weather, and uptake notes), so field entries match the City's schema from the start?
    ESRI record will not be specific to the federal and State level reporting requirement. Its record will only indicate the tree is under EAB treatment. Details should be submitted in the specified reporting format.

62. For right-of-way trees, will traffic control or right-of-way permits be required, and who is responsible for providing them?

    When necessary, contractor can invoice the cost to the city.

63. Section 5.1 states that all pesticide applications must comply with CDA pre- and post-notification requirements. Will the City be sending postcards or other pre-notification to residents, or is that the contractor's responsibility?
    It will be mutually agreed. Our plan for now is that City will provide the material and contractor should deliver to the house as they are in the front line.

64. What buffer distance from waterways and storm drains should be used for soil drenching?
    It would be at least 25ft for intermittent drainageway (e.g. storm drain inlet, curb inlet, catch basin**,** Ditch, swale, intermittent drainageway) and at least 50ft for stream, pond, river, wetland, lakes. But we will follow manufacturers' instruction for that.

65. After clearing much from the root zone, is the contractor expected to replace it?
    Yes.